

**CIVIC
EDUCATION**



School & Community Partnership Toolkit for Civic Education

Table of Contents

The Importance of Partnerships.....	3
Best Practices.....	4
Possible Collaborations.....	6
Case Examples.....	7
Integrating Strategic Nonviolence.....	8
Resources.....	10

Importance of Civic Education and Community Collaboration



Why Civic Education Matters

The strongest Civic Education is characterized by a mutual relationship between civic knowledge and civic participation. This is as civic participation gives individuals power, not just practice nor symbolic engagement. Civic education is not neutral in nature and it should promote strong decision-making and active participation skills.



Benefits of Community Collaboration

When civic education is delivered through schools and partnerships with community organizations it is more impactful. Collaborative programs such as hubs, initiatives, and coalitions provide hands-on experiences to civic engagement opportunities for all, including marginalized groups. This helps close the gap between civic education and civic engagement.



Impact

Civic education and engagement benefit individuals and communities. It helps develop leadership skills, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills. It is important that civic education includes all voices as research has consistently proven that the inclusion of marginalized communities increases rates of civic engagement in states. Addressing all social issues brings awareness and allows for change to be enacted.

Best Practices for Civic Education (Community Rooted Models)

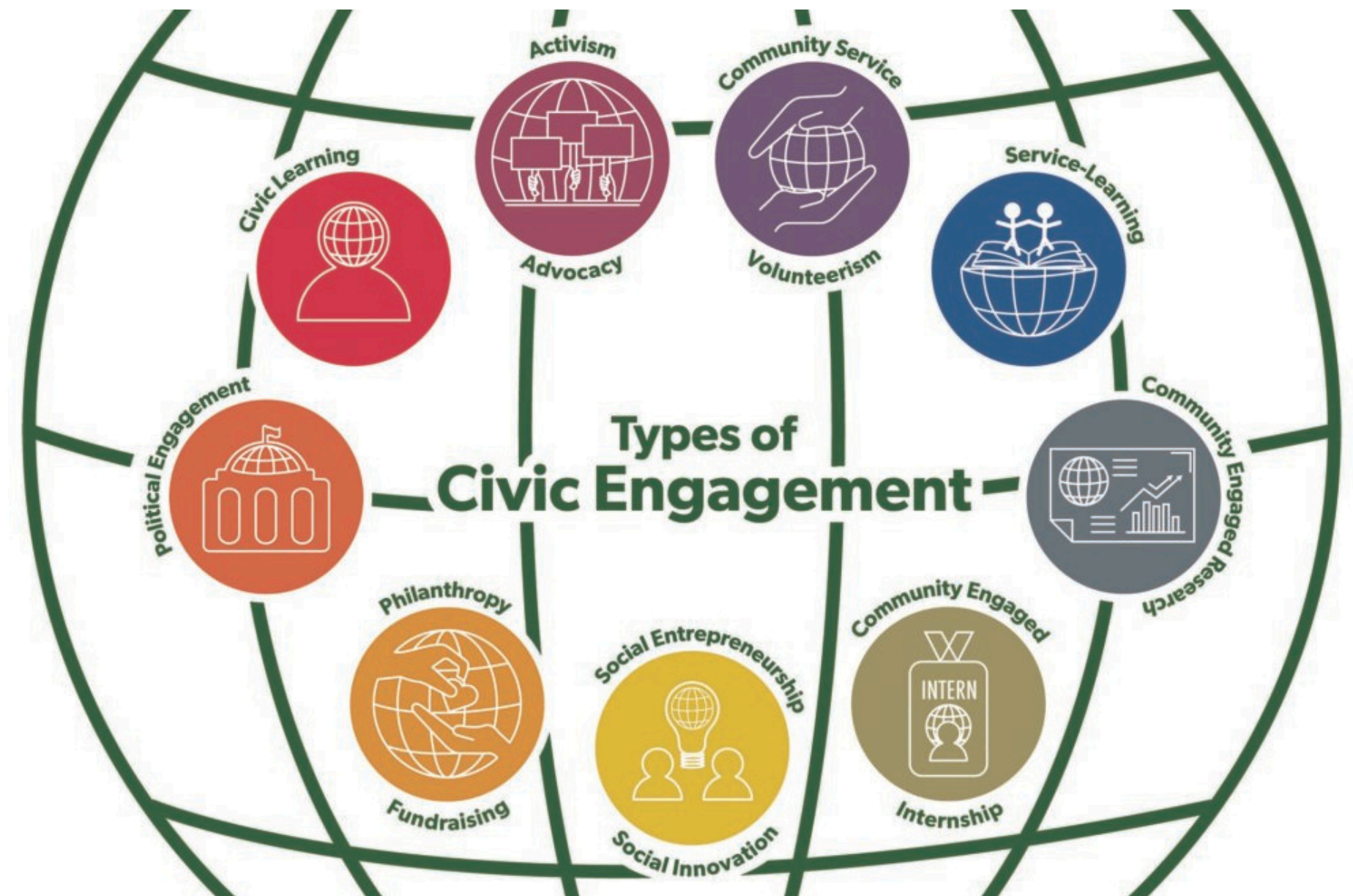
Step 1--> Create a democratic classroom/environment

Step 2--> Choose a focus issue that is important to the individual and members of their community

Step 3--> Take action and build relationships

Step 4--> Research and create an action plan

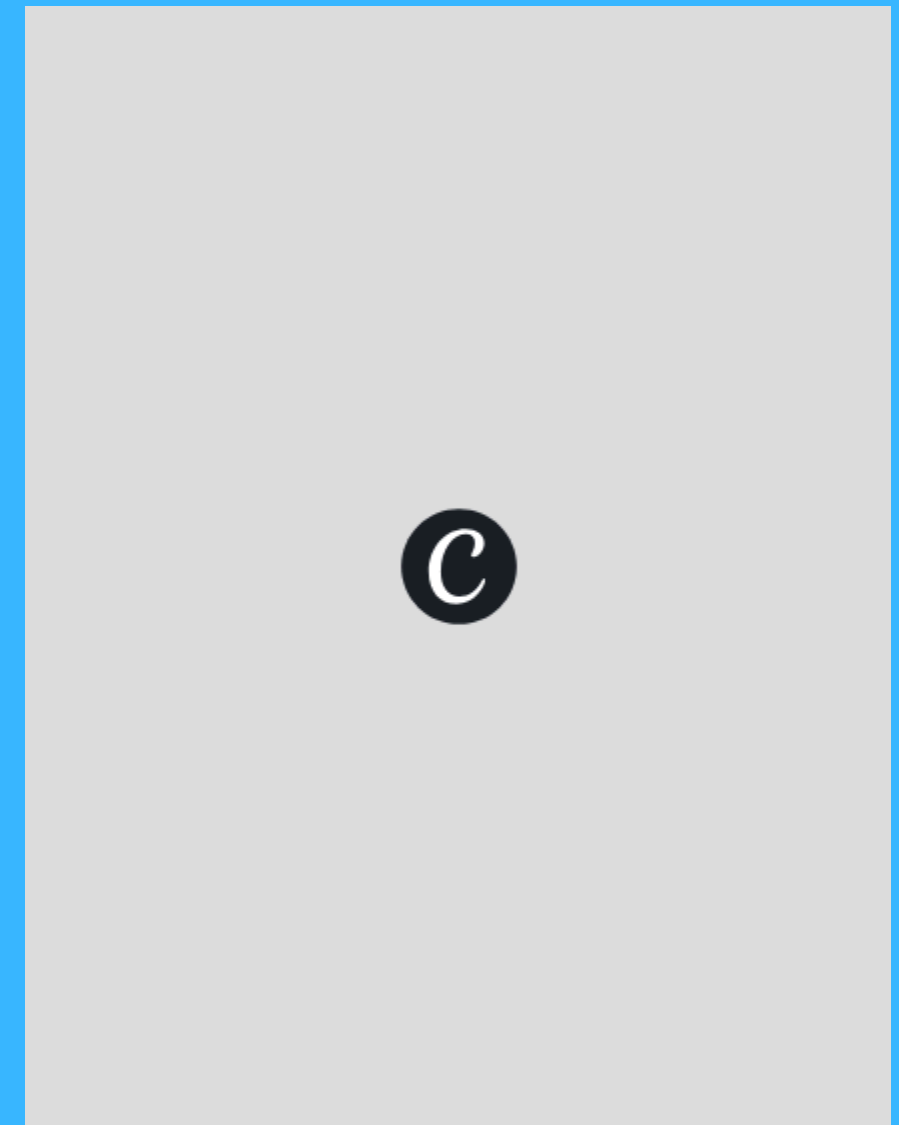
Step 5--> Share results



Best Practices (Hands on Models)



1. Adopt an Action Civics approach
2. Design interactive, student centered lessons
3. Foster inclusive and participatory problem solving
4. Building coalitions and partnerships



Double click to interact with the full best practices memo



Possible collaborations between schools and community organizations (Community Infrastructure)

- Media Literacy Coalition
- Civic Education Coalition
- Center for Civic Education
- County Education Foundations



Case Examples

State competition and requirements that have proven to increase rates of civic education

Statewide Civics Competition: actively engages students to showcase their knowledge and incentivizes them with prizes

- The University of Delaware's Center for Civics Education partnered with the U.S. Chamber of Commerce Foundation to make this possible

- Ultimately, this competition could be replicated and spread to other states

Requiring at least a semester of civic education in high school to be able to graduate:

- Many states require a semester of civic education before graduation

- Interactive lessons, curriculum, and projects allow students to engage in real world civic opportunities/engagement
- Ultimately, this could be done in all states

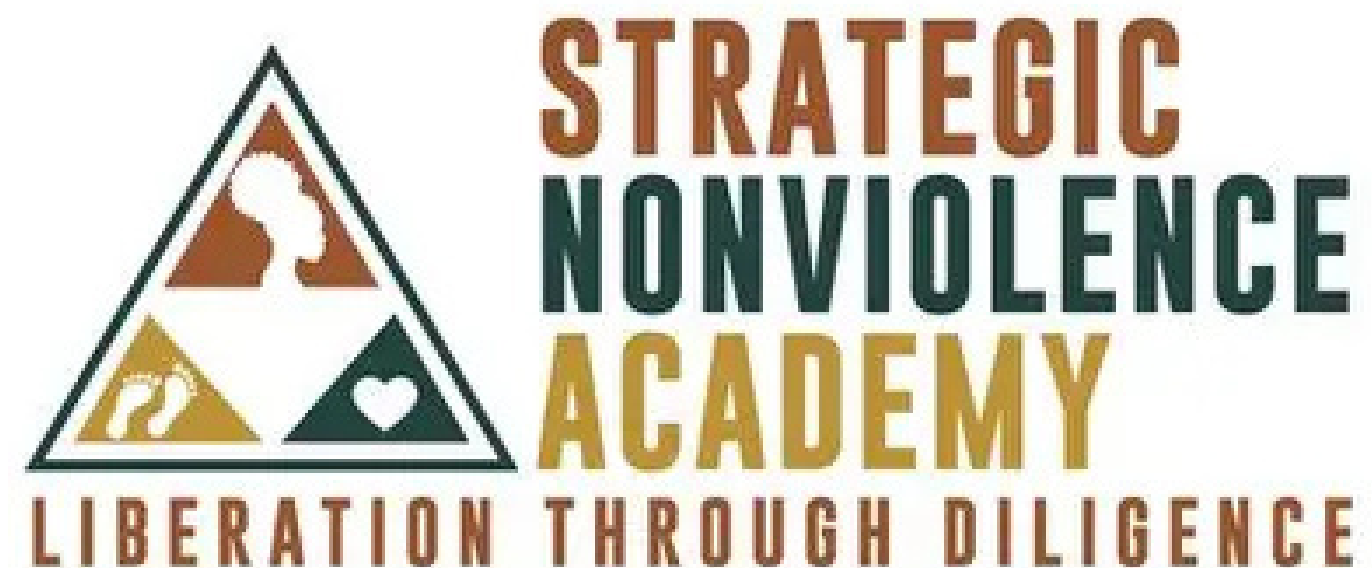
Strategic Nonviolence



IT IS VERY IMPORTANT TO INTEGRATE STRATEGIC NONVIOLENCE FRAMEWORKS IN CIVIC
EDUCATION WORK

IT IS USED TO EMPOWER INDIVIDUALS TO ADVOCATE FOR JUSTICE IN THEIR COMMUNITIES

IT IS NOT PASSIVE BUT RATHER A MORALLY GROUNDED APPROACH THAT
ENCOURAGES ACTIVE BROAD PARTICIPATION



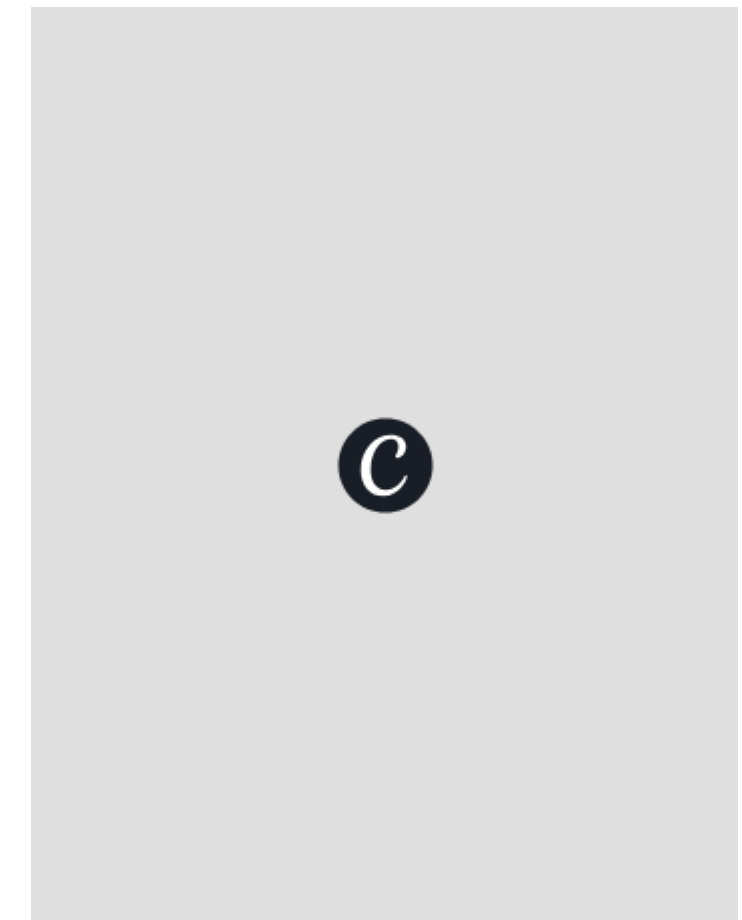
How to Implement Strategic Nonviolence in Classrooms and Communities

1. Establishing Nonviolent Norms
2. Using nonviolent tactics in lessons
3. Addressing systemic inequities

Double click to interact with the full nonviolence brief

Hands on application ideas

- Curriculum Integration
- Role Playing and Simulations
- Service Learning Projects



Resources

For more information on Delaware education visit the links below

<https://www.udel.edu/academics/colleges/biden-school/research-public-service/ipa/public-service/dcce/>

<https://education.delaware.gov/educators/academic-support/standards-and-assessments/social-studies/>

<https://education.delaware.gov/>